



Willow the Bunny Lovey

A crocheted comforter pattern • Design Code NS 10

No small parts

Advanced beginner

2-3 hours

Stitch counts verified

Finished size: blanket approx. 26 cm (10 in) square after 20 rounds • head approx. 4.9 cm across • approx. 25 cm from ear tips to corner

DK cotton on a 3.5 mm hook • embroidered face, no safety eyes • make 1 head + 2 ears + 1 granny square

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SAFETY — A BABY ITEM, READ THIS

No safety eyes, buttons, beads or removable parts. The face is fully embroidered and every floss end is knotted inside the head.

Willow is not a tested toy (ASTM F963 / EN 71). Never list or describe her as “baby-safe”.

Comforters are not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months — use with supervision, and say so in your listing.

Sew every seam twice. Weave every end in at least 5 cm (2 in).

Materials

- **Yarn** DK (#3) 100% cotton (or a baby-safe certified blend), approx. 60 g / 140-150 m — cream, sage, dusty pink or pale grey, plus a scrap of contrast cotton for embroidery. Only the head is stuffed.
- **Hook** 3.5 mm (US E/4) for the blanket; 3.0 mm for the head if your tension is loose.
- **Face** dark brown or charcoal cotton floss. No safety eyes.
- **Also** approx. 8 g fibre fill, tapestry needle, stitch marker.

The three pieces

Piece	Qty	Hook	Rounds	Finished size
Head (stuffed)	1	3.0-3.5 mm	1-15	≈ 4.9 cm across, 5.7 cm tall
Ears (unstuffed)	2	3.0-3.5 mm	1-11	long + floppy, sewn flat
Granny-square blanket	1	3.5 mm	1-20 + border	≈ 26 cm square

Gauge

1 dc ≈ 4.3 mm wide and 1 round ≈ 3.8 mm deep. After blanket Rnd 3, 9 dc along an edge should measure ≈ 39 mm (1.5 in).

Narrower? Go up a hook size — or keep the hook and add rounds (22 rounds ≈ 28 cm).

Abbreviations — US terms (UK in parentheses)

MR = magic ring • ch = chain • sl st = slip stitch • sc = single crochet (UK dc) • dc = double crochet (UK tr) • inc = increase — work 2 sc in the same stitch • dec = decrease — sc2tog over 2 sts • Rnd = round • () = stitch count at the end of the round.

On the head and ears, chains are never counted as stitches. On the blanket, the beginning ch-3 of each round counts as one dc.

Before you begin

Construction at a glance

- **Spiral pieces.** The head and ears are worked in a continuous spiral — no joins, stitch marker in the first stitch of every round, never turn.
- **Blanket.** The blanket is worked in joined rounds — each round closes with a slip stitch and the next begins with a ch-3 that counts as your first dc. Never turn.
- **Loops.** Work every stitch through both loops unless noted.

Three techniques that make this pattern

- **1. Magic ring & spiral** — the head and each ear begin with a magic ring; pull the tail tight after round one.
- **2. The granny-square corner** — every blanket corner is (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into one corner space. Those four corners make the piece square instead of round. Miss one corner group and the whole square pulls out of true — check all four at the end of every round.
- **3. The border round** — a final round of single crochet around the edge, with 3 sc into each corner space, squares the edge and stops the blanket curling. Do not skip it.

Sizing the blanket

Rounds	Approx. size (square)	Use
18 rounds	≈ 23 cm (9 in)	small comforter / preemie gift
20 rounds	≈ 26 cm (10 in)	the classic Willow (this pattern)
22 rounds	≈ 28 cm (11 in)	bigger lovey, same recipe

The square grows ≈ 1.3 cm per side per round — add rounds two at a time to grow Willow gracefully.

1 • Head — make 1

Continuous spiral, no joins. Marker in the first stitch of every round.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	pull ring tight
2	inc in each st around	12	
3	[sc, inc] × 6	18	
4	[2 sc, inc] × 6	24	ears attach at Rnds 4-6
5	[3 sc, inc] × 6	30	
6	[4 sc, inc] × 6	36	full width
7	sc in each st around	36	
8	sc in each st around	36	face on Rnds 8-9
9	sc in each st around	36	
10	sc in each st around	36	
11	[4 sc, dec] × 6	30	begin stuffing firmly
12	[3 sc, dec] × 6	24	
13	[2 sc, dec] × 6	18	top up stuffing
14	[sc, dec] × 6	12	
15	dec × 6	6	fasten off, close the hole

The decrease ladder must step 36 → 30 → 24 → 18 → 12 → 6 — one round each for [4 sc, dec], [3 sc, dec], [2 sc, dec], [sc, dec], then dec. That is why the head has 15 rounds.
Stuff FIRMLY — a soft head collapses when gripped and the face distorts. Finished head ≈ 4.9 cm across and 5.7 cm tall. Fasten off and close with the tail.

2 · Ears — make 2 (do not stuff)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	
2	[sc, inc] × 3	9	
3	[2 sc, inc] × 3	12	widest point
4–8	sc in each st around (5 rnds)	12	the long, floppy part
9	[2 sc, dec] × 3	9	
10	sc in each st around	9	taper to the base
11	[sc, dec] × 3	6	flatten, fasten off long tail

Pinch each ear base flat and fasten off with a long tail. Sew the ears to Rnds 4–6 of the head, about 10 stitches apart, pinching each base so the ear flops forward. A drop of invisible stitching across the base keeps the flop in place after washing.

3 • Granny-square blanket

3.5 mm hook, joined rounds (close every round with a slip stitch; the starting ch-3 counts as a dc; never turn).

- **Foundation.** Ch 4 and sl st to the first ch to form a ring.
- **Rnd 1.** Ch 3 (counts as first dc), 2 dc in the ring, [ch 2, 3 dc in the ring] × 3, ch 2, sl st to the top of the ch-3. [12 dc, 4 corner spaces]
- **Rnd 2.** Sl st into the next corner space; ch 3, 2 dc in that space, ch 2, 3 dc in the same space (first corner); then (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into each remaining corner space; sl st to close. [24 dc]
- **Rnd 3 (setup).** Sl st into the next corner space; ch 3, (2 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) in the same space; *3 dc in the next side space, (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) in the next corner space*; repeat from * around; sl st to close. [36 dc]
- **Rnds 4-20.** As Rnd 3 — 3 dc into every side space and (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into every corner space. Each round adds one 3-dc group to every side (+12 dc per round): Rnd 4 has 2 side spaces per side ... Rnd 20 has 18.

COUNT CHECK — before you close any round
Four crisp (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) corners — every time. Then total double crochets:
Rnd 3 = 36 | Rnd 5 = 60 | Rnd 10 = 120 | Rnd 15 = 180 | Rnd 20 = 240 (60 dc per edge ≈ 26 cm)

Border — do not skip

Work one final round of sc all the way around: 1 sc into each dc and 3 sc into each corner space, then sl st and fasten off. At Rnd 20 that is 240 sc + 12 corner sc = 252 sc. This firms the edge and stops the square curling. Open dc clusters and crisp (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) corners keep the square true round after round.

Stitch-count journey

Rnd	3	5	10	15	20	Border
total sts	36	60	120	180	240	252 sc

4 • Face & assembly

The face — embroidery only

- **Eyes:** two small ovals, about 8 stitches apart, across Rnds 8–9 of the head.
- **Nose:** a small inverted triangle centred between and just below the eyes.
- **Mouth:** a shallow Y from the base of the nose.
- **Ends:** knot every floss end inside the head and bury the tails before closing. Skip blush — chalk rubs off on bedding and is not washable.

Joining the head to the blanket

Centre the head over one corner of the square, overlapping the blanket by about 3 cm. Sew all the way around the base of the head — then sew it a second time. This is the only structural seam and it will be pulled, chewed and washed. Weave every end in at least 5 cm (2 in).

Why two passes? Amigurumi-to-flat seams carry the whole weight of the head. Two passes with the long tail, worked through both the head base and the blanket corner rounds, survive chewing and machine washing.

For your Etsy listing

- **Materials:** 100% cotton, embroidered face, no safety eyes, no buttons, beads or removable parts.
- **Care:** machine wash cool on a gentle cycle inside a mesh bag; reshape while damp and dry flat. Do not tumble dry — cotton can shrink and the stuffing may clump.
- **Supervision:** comforters are not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months; use with supervision. Copy this into your listing.
- **Colorways:** cream, sage, dusty pink, pale grey and butter yellow — neutrals outsell brights in the baby category.

Troubleshooting

- **Blanket curls / not square?** you skipped the sc border, or missed a (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) corner. Check all four corners at the end of every round, and do not skip the border round.
- **Came out too small / head flops?** your gauge is tighter than 4.3 mm per dc — go up a hook size or add rounds (22 rounds ≈ 28 cm). Stuff the head firmly and sew the base seam twice.

Why this pattern works — validation summary

Every stitch count in this pattern was checked with deterministic math (Crochet Pattern Checker): round-by-round production vs. consumption, stated counts, size claims against the stated gauge, and the granny-square growth model.

Check	Result
Head Rnds 1-15: count chain 6 → 36 → 6	✓ verified
Ear Rnds 1-11: count chain 6 → 12 → 6	✓ verified
Granny square: +12 dc per round, 12 → 240 over 20 rnds	✓ verified
Border: 240 dc + 4 × 3 corner sc = 252 sc	✓ verified
Sizes vs. gauge: 18/20/22 rounds ≈ 23/26/28 cm	✓ verified
Gauge probe: 9 dc ≈ 39 mm after Rnd 3	✓ verified
Head size: 36 sts ≈ 4.9 cm across; 15 rnds ≈ 5.7 cm tall	✓ verified

5 · Terms of use

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SAFETY REMINDER

Willow has NO safety eyes, buttons, beads or removable parts — the face is embroidered and floss ends are knotted inside the head. Even so she is not a tested toy (ASTM F963 / EN 71): do not claim “baby-safe”. Comforters are not recommended in a cot for babies under 12 months and should be used with supervision; sew every seam twice and weave ends in at least 5 cm.

Happy crocheting! Tag your makes with #NovalityStore and #WillowTheBunnyLovey — thank you for supporting an independent pattern designer.